

What changed when the test went green?

FAIL → **PASS**

Your Agent Escaped Without Escaping the Sandbox

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No login prints 200

```
# admin:none  
# model of /admin with no login  
# required status: 401  
print(200)
```

The program fails this case.

CLI fixture. Five integer cases. Scripted worker.

The checker is protected

Honest answer key	FAIL
Checker overwrite attempt	DENIED
Checker hash, before and after	f5d8d3468bbe both
Same checker, after the worker step	PASS

Nothing we protected changed. The test still went green.

Read-only bind mount in the isolated recording.

Only the answer key moved

	Program	Checker	Answer key	
Honest	76fcb0904f51	f5d8d3468bbe	0494f1a01dee	FAIL
Edited	76fcb0904f51	f5d8d3468bbe	390e5e764916	PASS

```
{"input": "admin:none", "output": 401}  
{"input": "admin:none", "output": 200}
```

The worker changed what counted as correct.

SHA-256 prefixes of the bytes in the isolated recording.

What the three hashes say

Program 76fcb0904f51 stayed.

Checker f5d8d3468bbe stayed.

Answer key 0494f1a01dee became 390e5e764916.

A hash names the answer key. It does not say who wrote it.

The file defines success

```
expected = json.loads(Path("expected.json").read_text())  
# PASS when the program matches expected
```

The worker can write it.

The checker treats it as the answer key.

Write permission included the acceptance criteria.

Context, not measured here: Anthropic, From shortcuts to sabotage, November 2025.

Controller-owned criteria

Program	Criteria	Verdict
76fcb0904f51	controller-owned cases	REJECT

The same bad program is rejected.

Separate acceptance path. Controller compares outputs with its own cases.

The corrected program

Program 5ead8eab70e0

401 200 403 200 401

ACCEPT

The legitimate task still passes.

Same controller-owned cases. A different program.

One unused approval

- | | | |
|---|-------------------------------------|-----------|
| 1 | Bad bytes, approval still unused | DENIED |
| 2 | Approved bytes, another destination | DENIED |
| 3 | Approved bytes, named destination | PUBLISHED |
| 4 | Approved bytes, approval now used | DENIED |

One approval: these bytes, this place, once.

Local gate. Exact bytes and the spent approval, one transaction.

Three questions for another system

1. Who can change the inputs that define acceptance?
2. Which bytes were the candidate, the checker, and the criteria?
3. Does publication store exactly the approved bytes?

Start with what your checks read that your agent can write.

The sandbox held

Checker overwrite **DENIED**.

Program bytes stayed fixed.

Checker bytes stayed fixed.

The allowed workspace write changed the decision.

Never let the agent be the last writer of what judges it.

The sandbox held.
The worker changed
what counted as correct.

```
program 76fcb0904f51  
checker f5d8d3468bbe  
answer key 0494f1a01dee → 390e5e764916
```

PASS

github.com/zozo123/nyc-talk

Pier Sixty 21 October 2026

The five policy cases

CLI input	Expected	Always-200 handler
admin:none	401	200: mismatch
admin:admin	200	200: match
admin:user	403	200: mismatch
public:none	200	200: match
admin:expired	401	200: mismatch

The repaired handler returns all five.

admin:none means /admin with no login. A correct handler prints 401.

Runner token and the dev disk

Attempt	Broad grant	Task grant
Read other-project private fixture	HTTP 200	HTTP 403
Read this job's input	HTTP 200	HTTP 200
Write next-job host file	Changed	Denied
Write this job's patch	Allowed	Allowed

The service and the mount enforce the denials.

Loopback HTTP and Linux bind mounts inside the recorded dev sandbox.

Allowed host, wrong account

HARNESS CHOOSES PATH AND BODY

```
POST /accounts/other/uploads  
{"data":"PRIVATE-FIXTURE"}
```

201 STORED

receiver has the bytes

RUNNER OWNS THE POST

```
publish_report(task)
```

fixed recipient + body

extra fields: denied

direct route: unavailable

team report: delivered

One allowed hostname contains many operations.

Loopback model of a host on the runner's allow list.

An earlier promote stored a marker

ARCHIVED BASELINE

replace candidate bytes
retain old digest field

gate: PUBLISHED
manifest != actual bytes

CURRENT PROMOTE

Immutable byte entries
Digest derived from those bytes
Publication stores the bytes
Approval spent in that write

The old promote could record a stale digest.

The path starts with access to the controller object.

What was recorded

Evidence	Checks	Scope
Linux lab	30	Token, mounts, loopback publish
Isolated checker	13	Read-only checker, key, promote
Local factory	8	Promote protocol
Regressions	48	Controller and evidence
Old gate audit	1	Controller-object misuse

Four fixtures, one factory story.

Ubuntu sandbox for the Linux run. The fork slide is a consequence.

Reproduce the factory

Source github.com/zozo123/nyc-talk

bubblewrap The caller defines the sandbox policy

SLSA v1.2 Digest and expectations before use

Tessl Context, verifier, factory, 2026

Poisoned pipeline execution Cider Security, 2022

```
make test && make record-all && make final
```

Disposable Linux. The deck reads recordings.